MIL-S-37546
18 August 1976

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

SCISSORS, GENERAL SURGICAL, STRAIGHT, 5-1/2 INCHES LONG

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers two types of straight, surgical scissors for use in general surgical procedures.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types. Scissors shall be of the following types, as specified.

Type

1 - Both points sharp
2 - One point sharp and one point blunt

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

GG-I-526	- Instruments, Dental and Surgical, General Specifications.
PPP-B-566	- Box, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-585	- Box, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-601	- Box, Wood, Cleated-plywood.
PPP-B-621	- Box, Wood, Nailed and Lock-corner.
PPP-B-636	- Box, Shipping Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	- Box, Set-up.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Hq., Defense Personnel Support Center, ATTN: Directorate of Medical Materiel, Code ATT, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

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MIL-P-116	- Preservation, Methods of.
MIL-L-10547	- Liners, Case and Sheet, Overwrap; Watervaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	- Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

ASTM E18	- Rockwell Hardness and Rockwell Superficial Hardness of Metallic Materials, Tests for.
ASTM E 92	- Vickers Hardness of Metallic Materials, Test for.
ASTM E140	- Standard Hardness Conversion Tables for Metals.

(Application for copies should be addressed to American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103).

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 General requirements. The scissors shall be in accordance with the applicable requirements of GG-I-526 and as specified herein.

3.2 Material. Scissors shall be fabricated from Class 4, type 420 material, except that the carbon content shall be 0.30 percent minimum. As an alternate, the chromium content shall be 12.00 to 15.00 percent and the phosphorous content 0.045 percent maximum.

3.3 Hardness. After proper stress relieving, the scissors shall have a Rockwell hardness of C50 to C55 when tested as specified in 4.4.1. The requirements of GG-I-526 shall apply.

3.4 Style, design and dimensions. Both scissors specified herein shall have straight blades and shall be suitable for use in general surgical and dressing procedures. Type 1 scissors shall have each point sharp and shall be in accordance with Figure 1. Type 2 scissors shall have one point sharp and one point blunt, and shall be in accordance with Figure 2.

3.5 Finish. Finish shall be mirror, except for the inside of the blades which shall be crocus finish.

3.5.1 Passivation. The scissors shall be properly passivated.

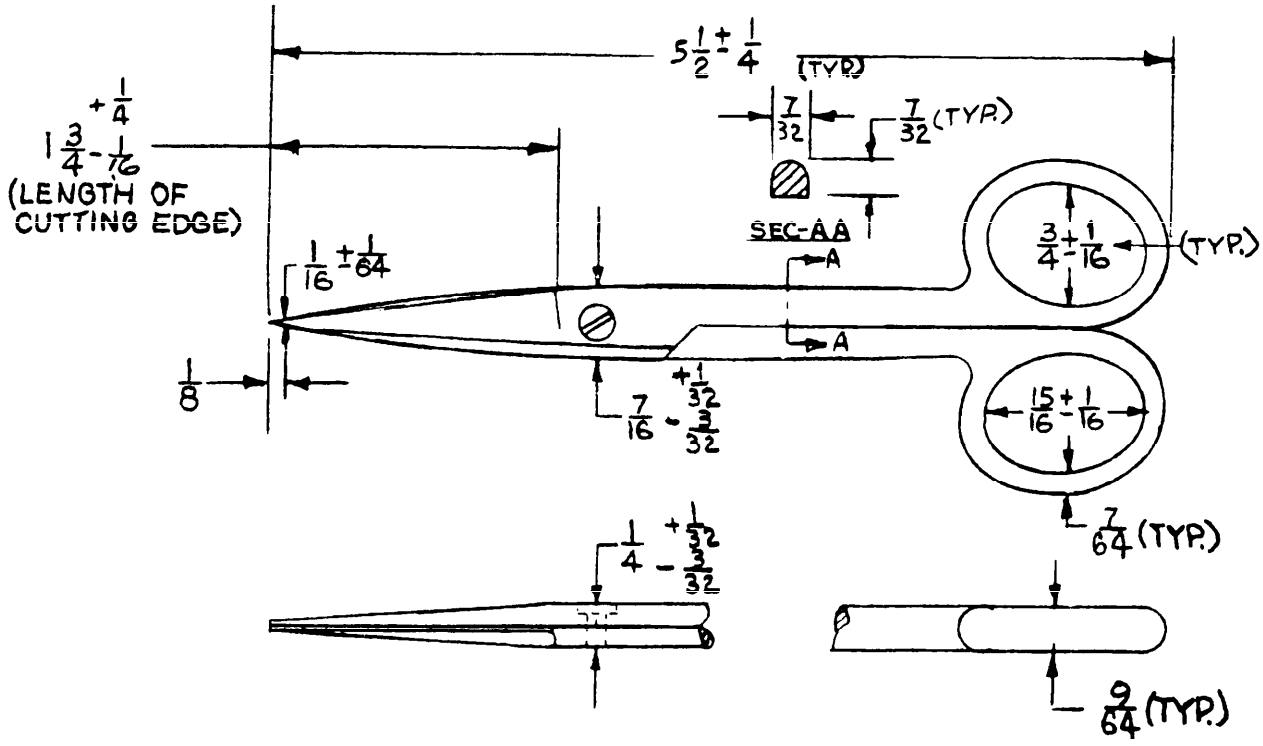
3.6 Cutting edges. Scissors shall cut a continuous length of at least 1-3/8 inches of the test material, when tested as specified in 4.4.2.

3.7 Identification marking. In addition to GG-I-526 requirements, scissors of foreign manufacture shall also be marked "stainless".

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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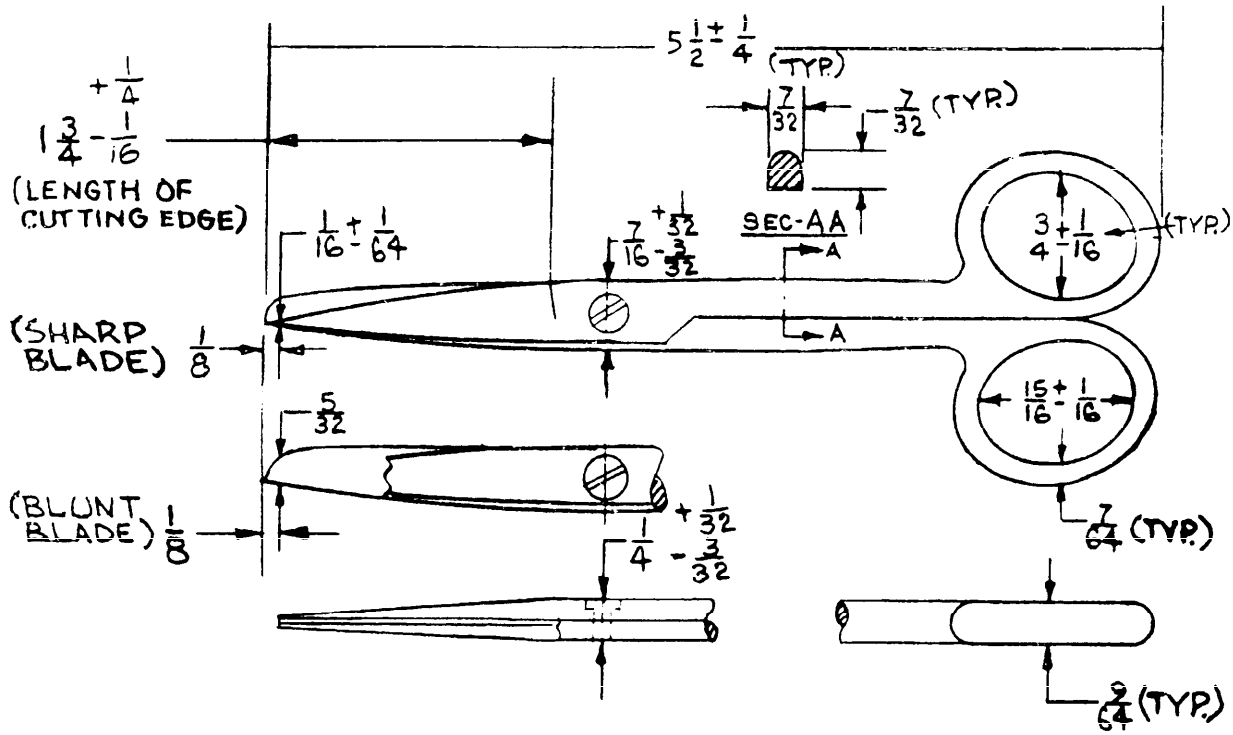


TYPE I

ALL DIMENSIONS ARE
IN INCHES
UNLESS OTHER SPECIFIED
TOLERANCE SHALL BE ± 1/32

FIGURE 1. Scissors, general surgical, straight, 5-1/2 inches long, both points sharp

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TYPE II

ALL DIMENSIONS ARE
IN INCHES
UNLESS OTHER SPECIFIED
TOLERANCE SHALL BE ± 1/32

FIGURE 2. Scissors, general surgical, straight, 5-1/2 inch, one point sharp.

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4.1.1 Inspection. Shall be in accordance with GG-I-526.

4.1.2 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the corrosion-resisting steel, may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the National Stock Number (NSN), the item identification, the name of the material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and as indicated in table I. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one scissors.

TABLE I. Sampling for examination.

Type of defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Major	II	1.0
Minor	II	2.5

4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and as indicated in table II. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one scissors. Where feasible, the same sample unit shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

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TABLE II. Sampling criteria for tests.

Component	Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Scissors	Hardness	3.3 & GG-I-526	4.4.1	S-2	1.5
	Dimensions	3.4	---	S-2	2.5
	Copper sulfate test	GG-I-526	GG-I-526	S-2	1.0
	Boil test	GG-I-526	GG-I-526	S-2	1.0
	Scissors performance test	3.6 & GG-I-526	4.4.2 and GG-I-526	II	1.0

4.2.3 Raw materials. A sufficient quantity of each lot of metal used in the manufacture of the scissors shall be selected for chemical analysis.

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 Examination of scissors. The scissors shall be examined to determine compliance with all the requirements contained in this specification. Examination shall be conducted as specified in tables I and III. Examination, however, shall not be restricted to defects listed in table III. Any scissors in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected, and if the number of defective scissors in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for the sample, the lot represented by that sample shall be rejected.

TABLE III. Classification of defects.

Categories	Defects
Critical	None defined.
Major	
101	Scissors not of the type specified.
102	Scissors not free from cracks, burrs, pits, rough areas, scale and corrosion.
103	Scissors not of the finish specified.
104	Tips of scissors not well defined for appropriate type.
Minor	
201	Identification markings not present, not correct, not complete and not legible.

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4.3.2 Packaging inspection. The inspection of the preservation-packaging and interior package marking shall be in accordance with the group A and B quality conformance inspection requirements of MIL-P-116. The inspection of the packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with with quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification and the marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Hardness test. Hardness shall be determined in accordance with ASTM Std. Method E18 or E92. Conversion of Vickers hardness values to Rockwell values shall be in accordance with ASTM Std. Hardness Conversion Tables E140.

4.4.2 Scissors performance test. The test material shall be rubber dam meeting the requirements specified for National Stock Number 6520-00-754-2769, Rubber Dam, Medium, 6 inches square. Three separate, consecutive tests shall be performed by each scissors as described and specified in GG-I-526.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Cleaning, drying and preservative. Each scissors shall be thoroughly cleaned and dried in accordance with the applicable method as outlined in MIL-P-116. Preservative shall not be applied.

5.1.1.2 Unit packaging. Each scissors shall be wrapped in neutral tissue or other suitable anticorrosive materials. Scissors shall be further packaged in accordance with MIL-P-116, method IC-1.

5.1.1.3 Intermediate packaging. Twelve (12) scissors shall be packaged in a box of appropriate size and design constructed in accordance with PPP-B-566, PPP-B-676 or PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the applicable box specification.

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5.1.2 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. Two hundred eighty-eight (288) scissors shall be packed in a box designed for a type 2 load, and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 3, style 3; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2 or PPP-B-636, class weather resistant, grade V3c. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.1.1 Case liner. Each level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall conform to applicable paragraphs of appendix thereto. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes. Fiberboard box shall be waterproof in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. Two hundred eighty-eight (288) scissors shall be packed in a box designed for a type 2 load, and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 1, style 3; PPP-B-601, domestic type; PPP-B-621, class 1; or PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Unit, intermediate and exterior container. Each unit, intermediate package and exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Number, title and date of this specification.
(b) Type required (see 1.2).
(c) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) Applicable National Stock Number.

6.2 This specification covers the following items appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog:

National Stock Number	Item Identification	Specification Designation Type
6515-00-365-1200	SCISSORS, GENERAL SURGICAL, Straight, 5-1/2 inches long, Both points sharp	1
6515-00-365-1820	SCISSORS, GENERAL SURGICAL, Straight, 5-1/2 inch, one point sharp	2

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DM

Project No. 6515-2018

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

OMB Approval
No. 22-R255

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE
MIL-S-37546 SCISSORS, GENERAL SURGICAL, STRAIGHT, 5-1/2 inches Long

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A
☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?
A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?
☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

TELEPHONE NO.

DATE

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